



Automated testing 20m

Automated testing describes the use of tools to execute test cases. Automated testing saves time and cost. Test cases that would take a human tester hours to execute, record and present results can be executed by a tool in seconds.

Another purpose of automation is to automate repetitive tests that have expected or known outcomes, so they can be repeated on a regular basis; for example, for regression testing to confirm previous builds or releases are still performing as expected.

Benefits of automated testing

There are multiple key benefits of using automated testing. Automatic testing:

- can automatically enter test data into the target application
- can generate detailed test reports
- enables playback of prerecorded and predefined actions; users can manipulate test data from these prerecorded test cases as needed
- allows test cases to be pulled from a database or spreadsheet to increase test data coverage
- allows test assets, such as requirements and defects, to be managed within the same tool
- may be integrated with other applications so that clients can view the results of testing
- can be executed at a preset time
- can be initiated remotely.

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To automate or not?

Scenarios that are suitable for automation are ones that are:

- high risk or business-critical (they should also be tested manually)
- executed repeatedly
- difficult or tedious to perform manually
- time-consuming.

It is possible to automate testing for some aspects of usability; for example, to test for accessibility, readability and functioning links. However, user acceptance testing, as its name suggests, requires an actual end-user to test and confirm your product is easy to use and performs as requested.

The key reasons for automation are to:

- increase test coverage
- increase test execution
- reduce repetitive testing
- test multilingual sites.

Watch *How to set up automated testing – Beginner's guide* (QA Madness, 2021)

(5:14)^{fnref:c47c88} to learn about automated testing and automation tools that are available to use. As you watch the video, pay attention to the automation tools mentioned and think about what sort of test cases should not be automated.

Select Play to begin.



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How To Set Up Automated Testing – Beginner’s Guide

QA Madness



Watch on

SHOW TRANSCRIPT



☒ Automation tools

Non-Assessed

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Mark each statement as True or False

	True	False
Selenium is one of the tools mentioned for automated testing.	☐	☐
Ranorex is listed as a recommended automation tool.	☐	☐
JUnit was one of the tools recommended for automation.	☐	☐
Katalon is an open-source tool as mentioned in the video.	☐	☐

Submit



☒ Test cases not suitable for automation

Non-Assessed

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Mark each statement as True or False

	True	False
Tests that are only executed once should not be automated.	☐	☐
Visual perception-based tests are ideal for automation.	☐	☐
Tests without clear pass/fail results are not suitable for automation.	☐	☐
CAPTCHA is an example of an anti-automation feature.	☐	☐
Tests for features with frequently changing requirements are not good candidates for automation.	☐	☐
Stable and well-defined functionality should not be automated.	☐	☐
Newly designed test cases that haven't been manually tested yet should be automated immediately.	☐	☐

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Thoughts on this page?

